

KEEP MOVING FORWARD

In a quiet little village, there lived a fourteen-year-old boy named Ezekiel, the son of a poor farmer. Every day after school, he helped his father in the fields. Despite their poverty, his family always made time to read the Bible together.

Ezekiel was known as a kind and generous boy. His parents taught him that people did not have to be rich to share. Even the smallest gift could become a blessing when given sincerely. So Ezekiel always tried to help others, even when he had little himself.

At church, Ezekiel was always enthusiastic about God's Word. He sat in the front row and carefully wrote down Bible verses and Pastor Samuel's messages. To him, God's Word was like a lamp guiding his life.

Some friends did not understand his passion and mocked him. "How can a boy like you serve God?" they asked. Ezekiel never argued. He simply smiled because he believed that God knew his heart.

One day, his father became seriously ill and could no longer work. Their financial situation grew worse, and Ezekiel had to leave school because his family could not afford the fees. He continued his father's work in the fields to help his mother.

One afternoon, a pastor saw Ezekiel working alone. "My son, aren't you tired from working so hard?" he asked.

"Of course I am tired, Pastor," Ezekiel replied. "But the Bible teaches me not to give up easily. I believe God is always with those who remain faithful."

The pastor smiled. "At such a young age, you have already become a good example. Keep holding on to your faith."

That evening, Ezekiel returned home and learned that his father had passed away. Seeing his mother crying beside his father's body, he could not hold back his tears. He remembered his father's words:

"My son, never give up. No matter how difficult life becomes, God will provide a way for those who continue to trust Him."

The days afterward were difficult. A few weeks later, the pastor who had met Ezekiel in the fields offered to pay for his education because he had seen his hard work, determination, and faith. With a grateful heart, Ezekiel returned to school and promised to study harder and remain faithful to God.

Several months later, a new student named Net joined his school. She was cheerful, friendly, and talented at playing the guitar. Her warm personality helped her make friends quickly.

During break time, Net introduced herself to Ezekiel. They discovered that they both enjoyed learning about God's Word. They soon became close friends and encouraged each other in their faith.

The following Sabbath, Ezekiel went to church as usual. During worship, he was surprised to see Net playing guitar in front of the congregation. After the service, Pastor Samuel introduced them properly.

“Net, this is Ezekiel. He loves God's Word very much.”

Net smiled. “It is nice to meet you again, Ezekiel.”

Ezekiel smiled back. “I am amazed that you are already using your talent to serve God.”

Net then invited him to help teach the children at Sunday School.

“Would you like to serve together?”

“Of course! I want to help children know God and His Word from a young age.”

From then on, they prepared Sunday School lessons together. They discussed Bible stories, chose worship songs, and prayed for the children. During Sunday School, Net led the worship with her guitar while Ezekiel shared God's Word. The children listened happily.

A few weeks later, on Ezekiel's fifteenth birthday, their school announced a singing competition. Net invited him to join, but Ezekiel was nervous because he had never competed before.

“Don't be afraid to try something new,” Net said. “We will never know what we can do if we are afraid to try.”

Ezekiel smiled. “Okay. Let's join.”

After school, Ezekiel helped his mother in the fields. While he rested under a tree, Net brought him a glass of water. She also gave him a small wrapped present.

Ezekiel opened it and found a beautiful Bible cover. His eyes filled with tears.

“Why are you crying?” Net asked.

“I am just touched. Thank you, Net. This is a very meaningful gift to me. The Bible always reminds me of everything God has done in my life.”

Net smiled. “Happy birthday, Ezekiel. I hope you will always be strong, humble, and faithful to God.”

On their way home, they saw a little boy sitting sadly beside the road. Ezekiel asked what was wrong. The boy explained that he had accidentally dropped his food into dirty water.

Ezekiel immediately opened his bag and gave him some bread and boiled potatoes from his lunch.

“Here, you can have these. They are some of the food my mother prepared for me.”

“Thank you, Brother!” the boy said happily.

Net looked at Ezekiel with admiration. “That was your own lunch.”

Ezekiel smiled. “It's okay. I can still eat at home. My mother taught me that we should share, even when we don't have much.”

Later, Ezekiel and Net practiced for the competition. Ezekiel sang while Net played the guitar. They chose the song “In Jesus Name” and practiced seriously.

Finally, the competition day arrived. When their names were called, Net confidently walked onto the stage, while Ezekiel stood nervously.

"Are you okay?" Net asked.

"I'm just a little nervous."

"We've practiced together. Let's do our best and leave the result to God."

Before performing, Ezekiel prayed silently, "God, please guide me. Give me courage, and let what we do glorify Your name."

They performed. As Net played the guitar, Ezekiel sang with all his heart. Slowly, his nervousness disappeared. He stopped thinking about winning and focused on giving his best for God.

When the results were announced, they won second place.

"We did it!" Net said happily.

But on their way home, Net became quiet.

"Ezekiel, I need to tell you something."

"What is it?"

"Tomorrow, I will move to another city. My father got a new job there, so my family has to move."

Ezekiel was shocked. The next day, it was time to say goodbye.

Before leaving, Net said, "Ezekiel, keep moving forward and never give up. Be a blessing to the people around you. Even though I will not be beside you anymore, believe that one day we will meet again."

Ezekiel smiled sadly. "Thank you for everything. Take care of yourself, and may God always be with you."

After Net left, Ezekiel remembered her words. "I will keep moving forward. I believe God still has a plan for my life."

Several years later, Ezekiel received a scholarship and studied theology. With his mother's support, he pursued his dream of becoming a pastor. The journey was difficult, but he remembered his father's words: never give up. He also remembered Net's message: keep moving forward.

After completing his studies, Ezekiel returned to his village to care for his mother and serve the community. When he returned to his old church, he met Pastor Samuel.

"Ezekiel? Is that really you?"

"Yes, Pastor. I'm back."

Pastor Samuel smiled proudly. "I still remember you working in the fields while studying God's Word. Now I can see how God has guided your life."

"Everything is because of God's love and guidance," Ezekiel answered humbly.

One day, Ezekiel was asked to serve patients at a local hospital. As he entered a room, he saw a woman playing the guitar during worship.

"Net?"

The woman turned around. "Ezekiel!"

They looked at each other in surprise, then smiled. Many years had passed, but they had finally met again, just as Net had promised.

Net had become a doctor serving the people in the village, while Ezekiel had returned as a pastor.

Net smiled. "Looks like God really kept His promise."

Ezekiel smiled. "Yes. The time is now."

They continued serving together. Net played the guitar while Ezekiel shared God's Word with the patients.

Afterward, Ezekiel sat quietly in the hospital yard and touched the Bible cover Net had given him years ago. He remembered his father's words: "My son, never give up." Then he remembered Net's words: "Keep moving forward."

Now Ezekiel understood that his difficulties were not the end of his story. They were part of the journey God used to shape him into the person he had become. He had once been a poor farmer's son sitting in the front row of a small church, dreaming of serving God. Now he had returned to the same village as a pastor.

He looked at the sky and smiled.

"Every step was leading me here."

Then Ezekiel returned to the church to continue serving. He finally understood that becoming a pastor was not simply his childhood dream. It was a calling that God had guided him toward, one step at a time.

"Keep moving forward, because God is always with you on the journey."